

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Tanmay Karkare

Address: 73 Northey Avenue Sutton SM2 7HU

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: The application site is located within an area that already experiences significant traffic congestion and peak-time pressure on the local highway network. The immediate vicinity includes a large primary school with a pupil capacity exceeding 1,000. This generates substantial pedestrian and vehicular activity during morning drop-off and afternoon pick-up periods. At these times, the surrounding roads are frequently congested, parking availability is extremely limited, visibility at junctions is reduced, and conditions for pedestrians - particularly children and accompanying parents - are compromised.

In addition, nearby recreational facilities, including tennis courts and a golf facility primarily used by elderly residents, generate consistent vehicular movements throughout the day and into the evening. These facilities attract both regular visitors and individuals who may have reduced mobility, thereby increasing the sensitivity of the area in terms of highway safety and pedestrian protection.

The proposed use as a place of worship or community assembly (whether temple, mosque, church, hall, or similar) would likely give rise to concentrated patterns of arrival and departure, particularly during evenings, weekends, and religious or community events. Such uses characteristically generate peak and overlapping traffic flows rather than dispersed movements. This would place additional strain on an already constrained road network.

The cumulative impact would likely include intensified congestion, increased on-street parking pressure, a higher risk of obstructive or unsafe parking practices, reduced access for emergency vehicles, and a material deterioration in road safety conditions for schoolchildren, elderly users of

nearby facilities, and other pedestrians.

When assessed in the context of existing conditions and the sensitive surrounding land uses, the site is not considered suitable for further high-intensity, assembly-based development. The proposal would materially worsen highway safety conditions and adversely affect the amenity of neighbouring residents.